

TECHNICAL DOCUMENTATION PACKET

Center for Houston's Future

The complete reference for the CHF website — how it's built, how to manage content, how to keep it running, and how to extend it.

Version

5.0.0

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Prepared by

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Theme

CHF (child of Hello Elementor)

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Overview

README.md

Version: 5.0.0 **Last updated:** April 2026 **Prepared by:** reneka DIGITAL

What this packet is

This is the complete reference for the Center for Houston's Future website — how it's built, how to manage content, how to keep it running, and how to extend it. Every file you need is here. Nothing is stored "in the consultant's head."

Keep this folder with your website assets. If you change vendors, hand this packet to the next developer on day one.

How to use this packet

The docs are split by audience. Start with the one that matches your role:

I'm a content editor (I update pages and publish news)

1. **CONTENT-GUIDE.md** — how to add pages, initiatives, and events
2. **ELEMENTOR-GUIDE.md** — how to use Elementor without breaking anything
3. **TROUBLESHOOTING.md** — when something looks wrong

I'm a site administrator (I keep the site running)

1. **MAINTENANCE.md** — weekly, monthly, and quarterly tasks
2. **LAUNCH-CHECKLIST.md** — pre-launch and go-live steps
3. **CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md** — record all logins here (fill in, keep secure)
4. **TROUBLESHOOTING.md** — diagnostics when things break

I'm a developer (I'm extending or debugging code)

1. **ARCHITECTURE.md** — how the theme is put together
2. **DESIGN-SYSTEM.md** — tokens, typography, components
3. **DEVELOPER-REFERENCE.md** — hooks, filters, PHP reference

I'm installing the site for the first time

1. **../INSTALL-GUIDE.md** — step-by-step WordPress + Elementor setup
 2. **../chf-import-split/IMPORT-ORDER.md** — if the single XML import fails
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Project at a glance

Domain	centerforhoustonfuture.org
CMS	WordPress 6.4+
Theme	CHF (child of Hello Elementor)
Page builder	Elementor Pro 3.x
Required plugins	Elementor Pro, Advanced Custom Fields Pro, Yoast SEO, Wordfence
PHP	8.2 required
MySQL	5.7+ / MariaDB 10.3+
Content	20 pages, 20 initiatives, 6 events, 32 nav items
Primary colors	Navy #1B2A4A · Green #56B84A · Gold #C9A84C
Typography	Inter (body) + Merriweather (headings)

Directory structure

```
chf-theme/
├─ style.css           Design tokens + child theme header
├─ functions.php       Setup, enqueues, includes
├─ inc/
│   ├─ custom-post-types.php    Initiatives + Events CPTs, ACF fields
│   ├─ security.php             Headers, hardening, cleanup
│   └─ elementor-setup.php      Dynamic tags, theme builder, defaults
├─ assets/
│   ├─ css/
│   │   ├─ design-system.css    Reset, typography, utilities
│   │   └─ elementor-overrides.css Widget-level overrides
│   └─ js/
│       └─ frontend.js          Scroll, counters, back-to-top
├─ elementor-templates/    10 importable JSON templates
├─ chf-content-import.xml  Full WXR import (78 items)
├─ chf-import-split/       Split fallback if full import fails
│   ├─ 1-pages.xml
│   ├─ 2-initiatives.xml
│   ├─ 3-events.xml
│   ├─ 4-nav-menus.xml
│   └─ IMPORT-ORDER.md
├─ INSTALL-GUIDE.md        Step-by-step installation
├─ _archive_v4/            Legacy files (do not use)
└─ docs/                  ← YOU ARE HERE
    ├─ README.md           This file
    ├─ ARCHITECTURE.md
    ├─ DESIGN-SYSTEM.md
    ├─ CONTENT-GUIDE.md
    ├─ ELEMENTOR-GUIDE.md
    ├─ DEVELOPER-REFERENCE.md
    ├─ MAINTENANCE.md
    ├─ TROUBLESHOOTING.md
    ├─ LAUNCH-CHECKLIST.md
    └─ CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md
```

Quick contacts

Role	Current vendor	Notes
Design & development	reneka DIGITAL	Theme, Elementor templates, content import
Hosting	<i>record in CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md</i>	
Domain registrar	<i>record in CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md</i>	
Email / DNS	<i>record in CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md</i>	

Where to get help

1. **Something broken after a WordPress update?** → [TROUBLESHOOTING.md](#)
2. **Content won't save or display wrong?** → [CONTENT-GUIDE.md](#) § "Common content mistakes"

- 3. Need to add a new page type or field? → [DEVELOPER-REFERENCE.md](#)
- 4. Site feels slow? → [MAINTENANCE.md](#) § "Performance"
- 5. Security alert from Wordfence? → [MAINTENANCE.md](#) § "Security response"

Documentation version history

Version	Date	Change
5.0.0	2026-04	Initial packet — full rewrite for Elementor Pro architecture

Architecture

ARCHITECTURE.md

How the CHF website is put together at a technical level. Read this first if you're a developer inheriting the project, or any time you need to understand why something is structured the way it is.

1. Stack overview

WordPress 6.4+ (PHP 8.2)	
Hello Elementor (parent theme)	
↓ extends	
CHF Theme (child, this repo)	
Elementor Pro 3.x	Page builder
ACF Pro	Custom fields
Yoast SEO	Meta + schema
Wordfence	Security

Why Hello Elementor as parent? It's Elementor's official starter, weighs ~12 KB, and ships zero opinions. The CHF child adds all design tokens, typography, custom post types, security headers, and Elementor dynamic tags on top.

Why a child theme at all? So you can update Hello Elementor safely without losing CHF customizations. Never edit the parent.

2. Theme file responsibilities

style.css

- Declares the child theme to WordPress
- Defines the `:root` CSS custom property system (all design tokens)
- Zero layout or component CSS — Elementor handles visual layout

functions.php

- Loads the three `inc/` modules
- Enqueues fonts and stylesheets in the correct order:
 - Parent Hello Elementor stylesheet
 - CHF child stylesheet (design tokens)
 - `design-system.css` (reset + utilities)
 - `elementor-overrides.css` (widget tweaks)
 - `frontend.js` (deferred)
- Registers navigation menus (Primary, Footer Utility, Footer Initiatives, Footer Leadership, Social)

- Declares theme support (HTML5, title tag, post thumbnails, custom logo)
- Adds preconnect hints for Google Fonts

inc/custom-post-types.php

- Registers `chf_initiative` CPT (20 items)
- Registers `chf_event` CPT (6 items)
- Registers `initiative_category` taxonomy (energy-climate, health-equity, immigration)
- Registers `event_type` taxonomy (conference, forum, workshop, dinner, summit, meeting)
- Registers ACF field groups programmatically via `acf_add_local_field_group` :
- **Hero Fields** (all pages/initiatives): `hero_eyebrow` , `hero_highlight_word` , `hero_subtitle` , `hero_background_image`
- **Event Details** (events only): `event_date` , `event_time` , `event_location` , `event_registration_url`
- Seeds default taxonomy terms on theme activation
- Flushes rewrite rules on activation

inc/security.php

- Sends hardening HTTP headers on every response:
- `Strict-Transport-Security` (HSTS, 1 year, subdomains)
- `Content-Security-Policy` (with `unsafe-eval` required by Elementor editor)
- `X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff`
- `X-Frame-Options: SAMEORIGIN`
- `Referrer-Policy: strict-origin-when-cross-origin`
- `Permissions-Policy` (camera, microphone, geolocation off)
- Disables XML-RPC (primary brute-force surface in WordPress)
- Strips `<meta name="generator">` tags (removes WordPress version fingerprinting)
- Disables in-admin file editing (`DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT`)
- Forces generic login error messages (prevents username enumeration)
- Removes RSD, WLW manifest, shortlink, feed links from `<head>`

inc/elementor-setup.php

- Registers the `chf-widgets` widget category in the Elementor panel
- Defines 4 custom Dynamic Tags (each guarded with `class_exists()`):
- `CHF_Hero_Eyebrow_Tag` → reads ACF `hero_eyebrow`
- `CHF_Hero_Subtitle_Tag` → reads ACF `hero_subtitle`
- `CHF_Event_Date_Tag` → reads ACF `event_date` , formats as "January 15, 2026"
- `CHF_Event_Location_Tag` → reads ACF `event_location`
- Enables Theme Builder locations (`register_all_core_locations()`)
- Sets Elementor global defaults on theme activation (colors, fonts, container mode)
- Adds body classes for Elementor-managed pages

assets/css/design-system.css

- CSS reset / normalization
- Typography scale using `clamp()` for fluid type

- Link styles, focus rings, button utilities (`.btn-primary` , `.btn-outline`)
- Section utilities (`.section-dark` , `.section-off` , `.section-gradient`)
- `.reveal` scroll animation class
- `prefers-reduced-motion` overrides
- `@media print` rules

assets/css/elementor-overrides.css

- Widget-level styling for Elementor's native widgets to match CHF brand:
- Heading, text-editor, button, nav menu, form, social icons, image, posts
- `.e-con` (container) max-width of 1200px
- Responsive breakpoints at 768px and 480px

assets/js/frontend.js

- Vanilla ES2022+ IIFE, zero jQuery
- `IntersectionObserver` -based scroll reveal
- Counter animation for stat numbers (supports `.stat-number[data-target]` , `[data-count]` , `.counter[data-target]`)
- Smooth scroll with reduced-motion respect
- Back-to-top button with scroll-threshold visibility
- Header `.scrolled` class toggle past 60px scroll
- Elementor frontend lifecycle hooks for dynamically-loaded widgets

3. Data model

Post types

Type	Slug	Archive URL	Single URL	Count
Page	<code>page</code>	—	<code>/{\$slug}/</code>	20
Initiative	<code>chf_initiative</code>	<code>/initiatives/</code>	<code>/initiative/{\$slug}/</code>	20
Event	<code>chf_event</code>	<code>/events-archive/</code>	<code>/event/{\$slug}/</code>	6
Post (news)	<code>post</code>	<code>/news/</code>	<code>/news/{\$slug}/</code>	as added

Taxonomies

Taxonomy	Applies to	Terms
<code>initiative_category</code>	<code>chf_initiative</code>	energy-climate, health-equity, immigration
<code>event_type</code>	<code>chf_event</code>	conference, forum, workshop, dinner, summit, meeting
<code>category</code>	<code>post</code>	(default WordPress categories)

ACF field groups

Hero Fields — attached to `page`, `chf_initiative`, `chf_event`, `post` - `hero_eyebrow` (text) — small uppercase label above the hero headline - `hero_highlight_word` (text) — word within the headline to gradient-color - `hero_subtitle` (textarea) — one or two sentences under the headline - `hero_background_image` (image) — optional background

Event Details — attached to `chf_event` only - `event_date` (date picker, stored as `Ymd`) - `event_time` (text, e.g., "6:00 PM – 9:00 PM CST") - `event_location` (text) - `event_registration_url` (url)

These are registered in PHP via `acf_add_local_field_group()` in `inc/custom-post-types.php` — **not** in the ACF UI. This means they survive plugin updates, site migrations, and database resets. Do not re-register them in the ACF admin UI.

4. Elementor Theme Builder layout

Elementor Pro's Theme Builder controls the non-content chrome (header, footer, single post templates, archives). All 10 templates are pre-built in `elementor-templates/` as JSON.

Template	File	Type	Displays for
CHF Global Header	<code>global-header.json</code>	header	Entire site
CHF Global Footer	<code>global-footer.json</code>	footer	Entire site
CHF Homepage	<code>template-homepage.json</code>	page	Homepage only
CHF Interior Page	<code>template-interior.json</code>	page	All other pages
CHF Initiative Single	<code>template-initiative-single.json</code>	single	Each initiative
CHF Event Single	<code>template-event-single.json</code>	single	Each event
CHF Events Archive	<code>template-events-archive.json</code>	archive	<code>/events-archive/</code>
CHF News Archive	<code>template-news-archive.json</code>	archive	<code>/news/</code>
CHF Hero Section	<code>section-hero.json</code>	section	Re-usable hero block
CHF Newsletter Section	<code>section-newsletter.json</code>	section	Re-usable CTA block

See [ELEMENTOR-GUIDE.md](#) for import steps and conditions.

5. Enqueue order and dependencies

Priority	Handle	Depends on
10	<code>google-fonts</code>	(none)
20	<code>hello-elementor</code>	(parent)
25	<code>chf-child-theme</code>	<code>hello-elementor</code>
30	<code>chf-design-system</code>	<code>chf-child-theme</code>
40	<code>chf-elementor-overrides</code>	<code>chf-design-system</code>
50	<code>chf-frontend</code>	(none, deferred)

JavaScript loads with `defer` so it never blocks first paint. CSS loads in order so cascade wins in the expected direction: parent → child → design system → Elementor overrides.

6. Caching strategy (runtime)

The theme itself does **no** server-side caching — that is the host's job. Recommended setup:

1. **Page cache:** WP Super Cache OR hosting-provided page cache (Kinsta, WP Engine, SiteGround)
2. **Object cache:** Redis or Memcached (via host)
3. **Asset cache:** Browser cache headers set by host, plus `defer` on JS
4. **CDN:** Cloudflare (free tier works) for image + CSS edge delivery

Do not install W3 Total Cache or WP Rocket without testing — they aggressively minify and can break Elementor's runtime-generated CSS for containers and custom colors.

7. Security posture

Layer	Mechanism
HTTPS	Enforced via HSTS header (1 year, includeSubDomains)
XSS	CSP + <code>X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff</code>
Clickjacking	<code>X-Frame-Options: SAMEORIGIN</code>
Brute force	XML-RPC disabled, Wordfence rate limiting, strong passwords required
Version disclosure	<code><meta generator></code> stripped, RSD/WLW removed
File integrity	<code>DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT</code> set, file perms 644/755
Login	Generic error messages, 2FA recommended
Database	Strong prefix (not <code>wp_</code>), Wordfence scanning
Backups	UpdraftPlus or host-managed daily backups (see MAINTENANCE.md)

8. What does NOT live in the theme

So there's no confusion:

- **Page content** — lives in `wp_posts` / `wp_postmeta`, edited in Elementor
- **Navigation menus** — live in `wp_term_taxonomy`, managed in Appearance → Menus
- **Site title / tagline** — managed in Settings → General
- **Widgets** — we don't use WordPress widgets; everything is Elementor
- **Redirects** — managed by Redirection plugin (install post-launch)

- **Forms** — Elementor Pro Form widget, submissions stored in Elementor → Submissions
- **Sitemap** — auto-generated by Yoast at `/sitemap_index.xml`
- **robots.txt** — served by Yoast; edit in Yoast → Tools → File Editor

Design System

DESIGN-SYSTEM.md

Every visual decision in the CHF site derives from the tokens in this document. Use these values verbatim — do not introduce new colors, fonts, or spacing scales without updating this file first.

1. Brand colors

All colors are defined as CSS custom properties in `style.css` under `:root`. Reference them in Elementor via **Global Colors** (already pre-configured on theme activation) or directly in custom CSS as `var(--token-name)`.

Name	Token	Hex	Usage
Navy	<code>--navy</code>	<code>#1B2A4A</code>	Primary brand color, headlines on light, heading text
Navy Deep	<code>--navy-deep</code>	<code>#0f1a2e</code>	Hover state for navy, dark section backgrounds
Green	<code>--green</code>	<code>#56B84A</code>	Primary CTA, accent highlights, links
Green Dark	<code>--green-dark</code>	<code>#3d8f35</code>	Button hover, pressed states
Green Light	<code>--green-light</code>	<code>#7dd870</code>	Gradient terminus (used with Green)
Gold	<code>--gold</code>	<code>#C9A84C</code>	Secondary accent, decorative flourishes
White	<code>--white</code>	<code>#ffffff</code>	Default backgrounds, reversed text
Off White	<code>--off</code>	<code>#f7f6f4</code>	Alternating section backgrounds
Rule	<code>--rule</code>	<code>#e5e5e5</code>	Dividers, borders, input outlines

Never use pure black (`#000`) for text — always `--navy` or a softer charcoal. Black-on-white is harsh and off-brand.

Accessibility pairs

Tested against WCAG AA (4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text):

Foreground	Background	Contrast	Body AA	Large AA
--navy	--white	13.4:1	✓	✓
--navy	--off	12.8:1	✓	✓
--white	--navy	13.4:1	✓	✓
--white	--green-dark	4.6:1	✓	✓
--green-dark	--white	4.6:1	✓	✓
--green	--white	3.1:1	✗	✓
--gold	--navy	4.8:1	✓	✓

Important: `--green` (#56B84A) on white **fails** body AA. Never use it for body-text links or small labels. Use `--green-dark` instead for any text smaller than 18px.

2. Typography

Font families

Role	Font	Weight range	Token
Headings	Merriweather (serif)	400, 700, 900	--font-serif
Body + UI	Inter (sans)	400, 500, 600, 700	--font-sans

Fonts load from Google Fonts in `functions.php` with `display=swap`. Preconnect hints are sent early to minimize blocking.

Fallback stack (if Google Fonts fails): - Serif: `Georgia, 'Times New Roman', serif` - Sans: `system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, sans-serif`

Type scale

Headings use CSS `clamp()` for fluid resizing between mobile and desktop with no breakpoint jumps.

Element	Desktop	Tablet	Mobile	Formula
H1	56px	42px	32px	<code>clamp(32px, 5.5vw, 56px)</code>
H2	40px	32px	26px	<code>clamp(26px, 4vw, 40px)</code>
H3	28px	24px	22px	<code>clamp(22px, 3vw, 28px)</code>
H4	22px	20px	18px	<code>clamp(18px, 2.5vw, 22px)</code>
H5	18px	18px	18px	<code>18px</code>
H6	16px	16px	16px	<code>16px</code>
Body	18px	17px	16px	<code>clamp(16px, 1.2vw, 18px)</code>
Small	14px	14px	14px	<code>14px</code>

Font family per level

- **H1, H2, H3** → Merriweather (serif)
- **H4, H5, H6** → Inter (sans) — smaller display headings read better in sans
- **Body, UI, nav, buttons** → Inter

Line height

- Headings: `1.15`
- Body: `1.6`
- UI / nav: `1.3`

Max line length

Body `<p>` elements are capped at `72ch` to keep reading comfortable on wide screens. Defined in `design-system.css`.

3. Spacing scale

CHF uses a modular spacing scale based on 8px. Use Elementor's built-in spacing controls and pick values from this scale:

Step	px	rem	Usage
0	0	0	Reset
1	4	0.25	Tight inline gap (icon to text)
2	8	0.5	Tag padding
3	16	1	Paragraph spacing, small gaps
4	24	1.5	Card padding, component gap
5	32	2	Section padding (small)
6	48	3	Section gap, large component gap
7	64	4	Section padding (default)
8	96	6	Section padding (large)
9	128	8	Hero section vertical padding

Never use arbitrary numbers like `37px` or `50px`. Round to the nearest scale value.

4. Layout

Container

- **Max width:** 1200px (set on `.e-con` in `elementor-overrides.css`)
- **Horizontal padding:** `clamp(20px, 5vw, 48px)` via `--container-pad` token
- **Alignment:** centered

Breakpoints

Matches Elementor defaults:

Name	Range
Mobile	up to 767px
Tablet	768–1024px
Desktop	1025px+
Wide	1440px+

5. Border radius

Name	Token	Value	Usage
Pill	<code>--radius-pill</code>	28px	Buttons, tag pills
Medium	<code>--radius-md</code>	12px	Cards, input fields, images
Small	<code>(inline)</code>	6px	Small badges
None	<code>(inline)</code>	0	Section dividers, rules

6. Shadows

Name	Token	Value
Default	<code>--shadow</code>	<code>0 4px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.06)</code>
Green glow	<code>--green-glow</code>	<code>0 8px 32px rgba(86,184,74,0.25)</code>

Avoid multi-layer shadows. One shadow per element, low opacity, soft blur.

7. Motion / easing

Name	Token	Value	Usage
Spring	<code>--ease-spring</code>	<code>linear(...)</code> (see style.css)	Elastic button press
Expo Out	<code>--ease-out-expo</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)</code>	Hero reveal, page enter
Quart Out	<code>--ease-out-quart</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.25, 1, 0.5, 1)</code>	Default UI transition

Duration

- **Hover / focus:** 150–200ms
- **Card lift / lift in:** 300–400ms
- **Page reveal / scroll fade:** 600–800ms
- **Counter animation:** 1800ms

Reduced motion

`frontend.js` and `design-system.css` both honor `@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)`. Animations either run instantly or cross-fade instead of moving. Do not override this.

8. Components

Button — Primary

- Background: `--green`
- Text: `--white` , Inter 600 weight
- Padding: `12px 28px`
- Border radius: `--radius-pill` (28px)
- Hover: background `--green-dark` , translateY(-1px)
- Focus: `--focus-ring` outline (`0 0 0 3px` `rgba(86,184,74,0.5)`)

Button — Outline

- Background: transparent
- Border: 2px solid `--navy`
- Text: `--navy` , Inter 600 weight
- Padding: `10px 26px` (slight adjustment for border)
- Hover: background `--navy` , text `--white`

Button — Text

- Background: none
- Text: `--green-dark` , Inter 600, underlined
- No padding
- Hover: text `--green` , underline thickens

Card

- Background: `--white`
- Border: 1px solid `--rule`
- Border radius: `--radius-md` (12px)
- Padding: 24px (mobile) / 32px (desktop)
- Hover: translateY(-2px), shadow upgrades to `--shadow`

Section (dark)

- Background: `--navy` or `--navy-deep`
- Text: `--white` (body) and `--green` or `--gold` (accents)
- Vertical padding: 96px desktop / 64px tablet / 48px mobile

Section (off-white)

- Background: `--off`
- Text: `--navy`
- Vertical padding: same as dark

9. Icon system

The theme does not ship its own icon font. Use **Elementor's built-in Font Awesome 6** (included with Elementor Pro) or SVG inline where precision matters.

- **Icon color on light:** `--navy` or `--green-dark`
 - **Icon color on dark:** `--white` or `--green`
 - **Standard size:** 20px (inline) or 24px (prominent)
 - **Stroke width:** 2px for outline icons
-

10. Do-not-dos

- **✗** Don't use `box-shadow` with more than 2 layers
- **✗** Don't add new colors without updating `style.css` tokens first
- **✗** Don't use Google Fonts other than Inter and Merriweather
- **✗** Don't use full black (`#000`) for text or borders
- **✗** Don't use italic for emphasis in body — use `<strong>` or `--green-dark`
- **✗** Don't animate anything longer than 1000ms on user interaction
- **✗** Don't override `--font-sans` or `--font-serif` on individual elements
- **✗** Don't use `!important` in any CSS file — the cascade is designed to work

Content Guide

CONTENT-GUIDE.md

For people who write, edit, and publish content on the CHF website. You do not need to know code to follow this guide. If something here seems technical, you can skip it — ask a developer.

1. Before you start

Get your login

You need: - WordPress admin URL (something like `centerforhoustonfuture.org/wp-admin/`) - Username or email - Password

If you don't have one, ask your site administrator.

Understand the three content types

Type	What it's for	Examples
Page	Static information	About Us, Our Team, Contact
Initiative	Ongoing strategic programs	Project Metis, Vision 2050
Event	Upcoming or past conferences, dinners, workshops	Annual Dinner 2026, Energy Summit
Post	Time-sensitive news and announcements	"CHF Releases 2026 Housing Report"

Choose the right type for your content. A news article should be a **Post**, not a Page. A conference should be an **Event**, not a Page.

2. Adding a news article (Post)

1. Log in at `/wp-admin/`
2. Click **Posts** → **Add New**
3. Fill in:
4. **Title** — headline
5. **Permalink** — will auto-generate from the title, edit if needed
6. **Content** — the body of the article
7. On the right sidebar:
8. **Category** — pick one (Press, Research, Announcements, etc.)
9. **Featured Image** — upload a 16:9 image, at least 1200×675 pixels
10. Scroll down to the **Hero Fields** block:
11. **Eyebrow** — short label, e.g., "PRESS RELEASE" or "ANNOUNCEMENT"

12. **Highlight Word** — one word from your headline to color green
13. **Subtitle** — one sentence summary
14. Click **Publish** in the top right

Time estimate: 5–10 minutes per post.

3. Adding an event

1. Click **Events → Add New**
2. Title the event — e.g., "Houston Climate Summit 2026"
3. In the main content area, write the event description (what it's about, who should attend, what to expect)
4. On the right sidebar, set:
 5. **Event Type** — pick one (conference, forum, workshop, dinner, summit, meeting)
 6. **Featured Image** — 16:9 hero image
7. Scroll to **Event Details**:
 8. **Event Date** — pick the date from the calendar
 9. **Event Time** — e.g., "6:00 PM – 9:00 PM CST"
 10. **Event Location** — venue name + city, e.g., "Hyatt Regency Downtown, Houston TX"
 11. **Registration URL** — full URL with `https://`, e.g., the Eventbrite or internal form link
12. Fill in **Hero Fields** (same as for posts)
13. Click **Publish**

After publishing: the event automatically appears in the Events archive at `/events-archive/` and on the homepage events block.

4. Adding an initiative

1. Click **Initiatives → Add New**
 2. Title the initiative — e.g., "Project Metis"
 3. In the main content area, describe the initiative (goal, approach, partners, outcomes)
 4. On the right sidebar, set:
 5. **Initiative Category** — pick one (energy-climate, health-equity, immigration)
 6. **Featured Image** — 16:9 hero
 7. Fill in **Hero Fields**
 8. Click **Publish**
-

5. Updating an existing page

Pages are built in Elementor. For content edits (changing words, swapping images, updating stats), you have two options:

Option A — Edit via WordPress editor (easiest, but limited)

Works if you only need to change: - Hero Fields (eyebrow, highlight word, subtitle) - Featured Image - Page title or SEO settings

1. Go to **Pages → All Pages**
2. Hover over the page and click **Edit**
3. Make your changes
4. Click **Update**

Option B — Edit via Elementor (full control)

Use this for changing any visible content, layout, or images inside the page.

1. Go to **Pages → All Pages**
2. Hover and click **Edit with Elementor**
3. Elementor opens in editing mode — the left panel has controls, the right side shows your page
4. Click any text or image to edit it in the left panel
5. When done, click **Update** in the bottom left
6. Click the ≡ menu (top left) → **Exit** to return to WordPress

See [ELEMENTOR-GUIDE.md](#) for detailed Elementor instructions.

6. Managing images

Where images go

All images upload to the **Media Library** (left menu → **Media**).

Size requirements

Image role	Min size	Aspect	Format
Hero background	1920×1080	16:9	JPG or WebP
Featured image	1200×675	16:9	JPG or WebP
Card thumbnail	800×450	16:9	JPG or WebP
Team portrait	600×600	1:1	JPG or WebP
Logo partner	400×200	2:1	PNG (transparent)

Before uploading — optimize

Unoptimized images are the #1 cause of slow pages.

Use one of these tools (free): - [tinypng.com](#) — drag and drop, downloads compressed - [squosh.app](#) — Google's image compressor - Photoshop → File → Export → Save for Web → JPG quality 70-80

Target file sizes: - Hero background: under 400 KB - Featured image: under 200 KB - Thumbnail: under 100 KB - Logo: under 50 KB

Alt text

Always fill in alt text. This is the short description of the image for screen readers and SEO. Example: - ❌ "IMG_3847.jpg" -
✅ "Houston skyline at sunset with Green Loop trail in foreground"

In the Media Library, click any image → fill in the **Alternative Text** field.

7. Hero Fields explained

Every page, initiative, event, and post has a hero section with three configurable parts:

Eyebrow

Short uppercase label above the headline. Gives the user instant context.

Good examples: - "ABOUT US" - "2026 ANNUAL REPORT" - "PRESS RELEASE"

Bad examples: - "This is a really long eyebrow that won't fit well" - Mixed case ("About Us") - Empty

Highlight Word

A single word from your headline that will appear in a green gradient. This creates visual emphasis on the most important concept.

Example: If your headline is "Building Houston's energy **future**", set Highlight Word to "future".

Rules: - One word only (a short 2-word phrase works, but one is best) - Must exactly match a word that appears in the page title - Leave blank if you don't want any highlight

Subtitle

One or two sentences that expand on the headline. Explains what the page is about in plain language.

Good examples: - "Houston's premier cross-sector think tank driving data-informed policy solutions." - "A decade of research on energy transition, health equity, and inclusive growth."

Bad examples: - "Welcome to our page" (generic) - Four paragraphs (too long)

8. Navigation menus

To add, remove, or reorder menu items:

1. Appearance → Menus

2. Pick the menu from the dropdown at the top (there are 5: Primary, Footer Utility, Footer Initiatives, Footer Leadership, Social)
3. On the left, find the item you want to add (Pages, Custom Links, Initiatives)
4. Check it and click **Add to Menu**
5. Drag to reorder on the right
6. Drag slightly right to make a sub-item (dropdown)
7. Click **Save Menu**

Menu hierarchy rules

- **Primary menu:** Max 7 top-level items, max 2 levels deep
- **Dropdowns:** Keep to 5 items per dropdown
- **Labels:** 1–3 words each, Title Case

9. Publishing vs drafting

Status	What it means
Draft	Saved but not visible on the site. Use while you're still writing.
Pending Review	You're finished but want a second set of eyes. Sends to admin.
Schedule	Auto-publishes at a future date/time. Great for press releases.
Published	Live on the site.
Private	Visible only to logged-in users with permission.

To schedule: click the date next to "Publish" in the top right, pick a future date, the button changes to "Schedule."

10. Common content mistakes

"I published but it's not showing up"

- Check the status — is it Draft or Pending?
- Is it assigned to the right category?
- Clear your browser cache (Cmd+Shift+R / Ctrl+Shift+R)
- If still not showing: **Settings → Permalinks → Save Changes** (this flushes the URL cache)

"The image looks stretched or cropped weird"

- Upload a larger image that matches the aspect ratio
- Check the required size in the Size Requirements table above
- In Elementor, make sure the image widget has **Image Size → Full** set

"The headline wraps weird on mobile"

- Short headlines work best (under 8 words)
- Use shorter words ("use" not "utilize")
- Check it on your phone before publishing

"Hero field isn't showing up"

- Make sure you saved/updated the page after filling it in
- Clear the browser cache

- If still blank: check that the Elementor template for that page includes the dynamic hero block (ask a developer to verify)

"I accidentally deleted a page"

- Go to **Pages** → **All Pages**, click the **Trash** tab at the top
- Hover over the deleted page and click **Restore**
- Deleted pages stay in trash for 30 days then purge permanently

"I broke the layout"

- Every Elementor save creates a revision
- In Elementor: click **History** (bottom left, rewind icon) → revert to the last good version
- Or: in WordPress editor, scroll to **Revisions** on the right sidebar → click the one you want → click **Restore**

11. SEO best practices (Yoast)

Every page/post has a **Yoast SEO** box at the bottom. Fill in:

1. **Focus keyphrase** — the one term you want this page to rank for
2. **SEO title** — 50–60 characters, starts with the keyphrase
3. **Meta description** — 150–160 characters, includes keyphrase, ends with CTA
4. **URL slug** — short, lowercase, hyphens not underscores

Example for a news post: - Focus: "Houston hydrogen hub" - SEO title: "Houston Hydrogen Hub: CHF's Role in Energy Transition" - Meta: "CHF's Hydrogen Hub initiative will position Houston as the center of America's clean hydrogen economy. Read the full plan." - Slug: `houston-hydrogen-hub`

Yoast gives you a green / orange / red indicator — aim for green. It's OK if readability is orange if content quality is high.

12. Style guide quick-reference

Capitalization

- Page titles: **Title Case** (Capitalize Major Words)
- Headlines (H1, H2): **Title Case**
- Body headings (H3, H4): **Sentence case**
- Eyebrow labels: **UPPERCASE**
- Buttons: **Title Case** ("Read the Report", not "READ THE REPORT")

Numbers

- **Under 10:** spelled out ("three initiatives")
- **10 and over:** numerals ("12 partners")
- **Stats:** always numerals (" \$28 billion", "2,400 leaders")
- **Percentages:** numeral + % ("67%")

Dates

- Events: "January 15, 2026" (full month, ordinal comma, year)
- News bylines: "Jan 15, 2026" (abbreviated, comma, year)

Em dashes vs hyphens

- Em dash (—) for parenthetical asides
- En dash (–) for ranges ("6:00 PM – 9:00 PM")
- Hyphen (-) for compound words ("cross-sector")

Avoid

- ❌ "!!" or "!!!" in headlines
- ❌ ALL CAPS for emphasis in body (use bold)
- ❌ Passive voice when active works ("The report was released" → "CHF released the report")
- ❌ Industry jargon on public-facing pages

Elementor Guide

ELEMENTOR-GUIDE.md

Everything you need to know about using Elementor on the CHF site — for both content editors making routine updates and developers building new layouts.

1. Opening Elementor on a page

1. **Pages** → **All Pages** in WordPress admin
2. Hover over the page, click **Edit with Elementor** (not "Edit")
3. Wait 3–5 seconds for the editor to load
4. You'll see:
5. **Left panel** — widgets and settings
6. **Right side** — live preview of your page
7. **Bottom bar** — save button, history, responsive preview

To exit: click the ≡ menu (top left) → **Exit to Dashboard**.

2. The 3 Elementor concepts you MUST understand

Containers

Rectangular boxes that hold widgets or other containers. Think of them like layers in a Photoshop file — everything is nested inside a container.

CHF uses **Flexbox containers** (the modern Elementor container system), not the old Section/Column system. All 10 templates are built this way.

Widgets

The individual building blocks: heading, text, button, image, form, etc. Widgets live inside containers, not on the page directly.

Templates

Full page layouts saved as reusable designs. CHF ships 10 templates (see [ARCHITECTURE.md](#) § 4).

3. Making safe edits

Editing text

1. Click the text in the preview

2. The left panel switches to that widget's settings
3. Edit in the left panel's text field, or directly in the preview
4. Changes apply live

Editing images

1. Click the image in the preview
2. In the left panel under **Content → Image**, click the current image
3. Choose from Media Library or upload new
4. Make sure **Image Size** is set to **Full** unless you have a reason

Editing colors

Don't set colors manually inside widgets. Always use Global Colors:

1. Click any text widget
2. **Style → Color → [globe icon] Global Colors**
3. Pick from the CHF palette (Navy, Green, Gold, etc.)

This way if the brand color ever changes, updating the global color updates every widget site-wide.

Editing typography

Same principle: use **Global Fonts**, not manual font pickers.

1. Click a text widget
2. **Style → Typography → [globe icon] Global Fonts**
3. Pick from the CHF scale (H1, H2, Body, etc.)

4. Common layout tasks

Adding a new section to an existing page

1. Scroll to where you want the new section
2. Hover between two existing containers — a "+" button appears
3. Click + → **Select your structure** → pick a column layout (most often full width or 2-column)
4. Drag widgets from the left panel into the new container

Duplicating a section

1. Right-click the container's handle (top-left corner of the container)
2. Click **Duplicate**
3. Drag the copy into position
4. Edit the content

This is the fastest way to add another "card" or "stat block" without rebuilding the layout.

Deleting a section

1. Right-click the container handle

2. Click **Delete**
3. Confirm

If you delete something by accident, use **History** (bottom left, rewind icon).

Changing column count on mobile

1. Click the container
2. Switch to mobile view (bottom bar → phone icon)
3. **Layout → Items → Width** → change to 100% for full-width stacking

Most CHF templates already handle this. Don't override unless the layout actually breaks on mobile.

5. Responsive preview

Use the bottom-bar device icons to preview:

- **Desktop** (default)
- **Tablet** (768px wide)
- **Mobile** (375px wide)

Every edit must look good on all three. CHF templates are built responsive, but custom changes can break mobile if you're not careful.

Mobile-specific rules

- Font sizes: H1 max 32px, H2 max 26px
 - Padding: reduce to 64px top/bottom on sections
 - Columns: stack to single column below 768px
 - Images: full width, 16:9 ratio
-

6. Theme Builder templates

These are the "master templates" that control the header, footer, and post page layouts. **Only administrators should edit these.** A mistake here affects the entire site.

Accessing Theme Builder

1. **Templates → Theme Builder** (in WordPress admin, under Elementor Pro)
2. You'll see cards for Header, Footer, Single Post, Archive, etc.
3. Click a card to open it in the editor

The 10 pre-built templates

Template	Controls	Conditions
CHF Global Header	Top nav, logo, menu	Entire site
CHF Global Footer	Newsletter, footer menus, social	Entire site
CHF Homepage	The home page layout	Front page only
CHF Interior Page	All other pages	Pages (not front page)
CHF Initiative Single	Each initiative's page	Initiatives CPT
CHF Event Single	Each event's page	Events CPT
CHF Events Archive	<code>/events-archive/</code> listing	Events archive
CHF News Archive	<code>/news/</code> listing	Posts archive
CHF Hero Section	Re-usable hero block	Inserted into pages manually
CHF Newsletter Section	Re-usable CTA block	Inserted into pages manually

Display conditions

When you first import a Theme Builder template, you must set its **Display Condition** so Elementor knows where to apply it:

1. Open the template in Elementor
2. Click **Publish** (or **Update** if already published)
3. A dialog appears: **Display Conditions**
4. Click **Add Condition**
5. Pick the scope from the dropdowns

For the 10 CHF templates, the correct conditions are documented in [../INSTALL-GUIDE.md](#) § "Theme Builder conditions".

7. Dynamic tags (ACF integration)

Dynamic tags let widgets pull their content from ACF fields — so the same template can show different content on different posts.

Available CHF dynamic tags

Tag name	Reads from	Where to use
CHF Hero Eyebrow	<code>hero_eyebrow</code> ACF field	Text widget above hero headline
CHF Hero Subtitle	<code>hero_subtitle</code> ACF field	Text widget below hero headline
CHF Event Date	<code>event_date</code> ACF field (formatted)	Event pages
CHF Event Location	<code>event_location</code> ACF field	Event pages

How to use a dynamic tag

1. Click a text or heading widget
2. **Content** → **Title** → [database icon on right]
3. The dropdown shows all dynamic tags — scroll to **CHF Fields**
4. Pick the one you want
5. The preview updates to show the current post's value

Where to use them

The pre-built templates already use dynamic tags. You only need to add them if you're building a new custom template that should pull post-specific content.

8. Popups (Elementor Pro)

CHF does not currently use popups, but Elementor Pro supports them. If you want to add one (e.g., a newsletter exit-intent popup):

1. **Templates** → **Popups** → **Add New**
2. Design the popup content with widgets
3. **Publish** → set **Display Conditions** + **Triggers** (exit intent, scroll depth, time delay)

Guidelines: - No more than 1 popup per session per user - Mobile popups must be dismissible with a large close button - Never auto-open within the first 5 seconds (Google ranks this as intrusive interstitial)

9. Forms (Elementor Pro)

The newsletter form and any contact form use the **Elementor Pro Form widget**.

Editing a form

1. Click the form widget in the editor
2. **Content** → **Form Fields** — add/remove/reorder
3. **Content** → **Actions After Submit** — control what happens:
4. **Collect Submissions** (always enable — stores in WP admin)
5. **Email** (sends to site admin)
6. **Webhook** (for CRM integration like HubSpot or Mailchimp)
7. **Redirect** (send user to thank-you page)

Where submissions live

Elementor → **Submissions** in WordPress admin. You can export as CSV.

Preventing spam

1. **Content** → **Form Fields** → add a **Honeypot** field (invisible to humans)
2. Enable **reCAPTCHA v3** via **Elementor** → **Settings** → **Integrations**

3. Use a site key from google.com/recaptcha

10. Performance tips

Elementor can generate bloated pages if you're not careful. Follow these:

Do

-  Use containers, not sections+columns (already done in CHF templates)
-  Use Global Colors and Global Fonts
-  Set **Image Size** on every image widget (don't leave on "Full" for thumbnails)
-  Enable **Improved CSS Loading** in Elementor → Settings → Experiments
-  Enable **Optimized DOM Output** in Experiments
-  Use the built-in Elementor icons (Font Awesome) rather than custom SVG uploads

Don't

-  Don't use 5 nested containers where 2 would work
-  Don't set custom CSS on individual widgets — use classes and the theme's stylesheet
-  Don't upload 5 MB hero images and let Elementor resize them
-  Don't use more than 2 Google Fonts (we use Inter + Merriweather only)
-  Don't disable the default CHF stylesheets to "start fresh"

11. Revisions and history

Elementor saves every change as you work. To revert:

1. **History** (bottom left, rewind icon)
2. **Actions tab** — step-by-step undo for the current session
3. **Revisions tab** — named snapshots from previous saves

Each save creates a revision. Revisions are kept indefinitely (or until you prune them with a DB cleanup plugin).

12. Custom CSS

Elementor Pro lets you add CSS at three levels. Use the lowest-possible level for any customization:

Level	Where	When to use
Widget	Click widget → Advanced → Custom CSS	One-off tweak to a specific widget
Container	Click container → Advanced → Custom CSS	Section-level override
Site-wide	Elementor → Custom Code	Global CSS or JS tweaks

Important: do NOT add site-wide overrides in Elementor Custom Code that could go in `design-system.css` instead. Keep the design system in the theme file so it survives Elementor uninstalls.

13. When Elementor breaks

"The editor won't load / shows a blank screen"

1. Deactivate any new plugin you added recently
2. Clear site cache (including browser cache)
3. Check browser console for errors (F12 → Console)
4. Try **Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data**

"My changes don't appear on the front end"

1. **Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data**
2. Clear page cache (WP Super Cache or host-managed)
3. Browser hard refresh (Cmd+Shift+R / Ctrl+Shift+R)

"Layout looks fine in editor but broken on live site"

Almost always a caching issue. In order: 1. Browser hard refresh 2. WP Super Cache → Delete Cache 3. Cloudflare → Purge Everything 4. Hosting panel → Purge server cache

"I can't undo a change"

1. **History → Actions** for this-session changes
2. **History → Revisions** for prior saves
3. **WordPress editor → Revisions sidebar** for very old versions

"A template imported but looks wrong"

Re-import it. Templates → Saved Templates → Delete the broken one → Import again.

14. Keyboard shortcuts

Action	Shortcut
Save	Cmd/Ctrl + S
Undo	Cmd/Ctrl + Z
Redo	Cmd/Ctrl + Shift + Z
Duplicate element	Cmd/Ctrl + D
Delete element	Delete
Finder (find widget)	Cmd/Ctrl + E
Toggle responsive mode	Cmd/Ctrl + Shift + M
Toggle navigator panel	Cmd/Ctrl + I

Memorize Cmd+S, Cmd+Z, Cmd+D, Cmd+E. Those four will save you hours.

Developer Reference

DEVELOPER-REFERENCE.md

For developers extending, debugging, or handing off the CHF theme. Assumes working knowledge of WordPress, PHP 8.2+, and Elementor Pro.

1. Development setup

Local environment

Recommended: Local by Flywheel, DevKinsta, or Docker (LocalWP is easiest).

Requirements

- PHP 8.2+
- MySQL 5.7+ or MariaDB 10.3+
- WordPress 6.4+
- Node.js (only needed if building custom widgets or compile steps — CHF ships no build process currently)

Setup steps

1. Install WordPress locally
 2. Install **Hello Elementor** theme (required parent)
 3. Copy `chf-theme/` into `wp-content/themes/chf-theme/`
 4. Install + activate **Elementor Pro**, **ACF Pro**
 5. Activate the CHF child theme
 6. Import content: Tools → Import → WordPress → upload `chf-content-import.xml`
 7. Import Elementor templates: Templates → Saved Templates → Import each of the 10 JSON files in `elementor-templates/`
 8. Set Theme Builder conditions per `INSTALL-GUIDE.md`
-

2. Coding standards

PHP

- Follow **WordPress PHP Coding Standards** ([link](#))
- 4-space indentation
- Opening braces on same line for functions, next line for classes
- Prefix all functions with `chf_`
- Prefix all classes with `CHF_`
- Prefix all hooks with `chf_`

- Never output HTML directly — use template functions or return strings
- Escape all output: `esc_html()`, `esc_attr()`, `esc_url()`, `wp_kses_post()`
- Sanitize all input: `sanitize_text_field()`, `wp_kses()`, `absint()`
- Use `nonce` verification on all forms + AJAX
- Document every function with a proper docblock

Example function

```
/**
 * Retrieve the formatted event date for a given post.
 *
 * Reads the ACF `event_date` field (stored as Ymd) and returns it as
 * a human-readable string.
 *
 * @since 5.0.0
 *
 * @param int $post_id The post ID. Defaults to current post.
 * @return string Formatted date or empty string on failure.
 */
function chf_get_event_date( $post_id = 0 ) {
    $post_id = $post_id ? $post_id : get_the_ID();
    $raw      = function_exists( 'get_field' ) ? get_field( 'event_date', $post_id ) : '';

    if ( empty( $raw ) ) {
        return '';
    }

    $date = DateTime::createFromFormat( 'Ymd', $raw );
    return $date ? $date->format( 'F j, Y' ) : '';
}
```

CSS

- Use CSS custom properties (tokens) from `style.css` — never hardcode hex values
- Mobile-first media queries
- BEM-ish naming for custom classes (`.component__element--modifier`)
- No `!important` anywhere
- Max file size: keep individual CSS files under 50 KB

JavaScript

- Vanilla ES2022+ only — no jQuery
- IIFE pattern for scoping
- Use `const` by default, `let` when reassignment required, never `var`
- Document with JSDoc
- Use `IntersectionObserver` over scroll listeners
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`

3. Theme hooks reference

Custom action hooks

None currently defined. If you add one, use the `chf_` prefix:

```
do_action( 'chf_before_hero', $post );
```

Filters

None currently defined. If you add one:

```
$value = apply_filters( 'chf_hero_subtitle', $value, $post );
```

WordPress hooks used by the theme

Hook	File	Function	Purpose
<code>after_setup_theme</code>	functions.php	<code>chf_setup</code>	Theme support, nav menus, image sizes
<code>wp_enqueue_scripts</code>	functions.php	<code>chf_enqueue_assets</code>	Styles and scripts
<code>init</code>	custom-post-types.php	<code>chf_register_post_types</code>	Register CPTs
<code>init</code>	custom-post-types.php	<code>chf_register_taxonomies</code>	Register taxonomies
<code>acf/init</code>	custom-post-types.php	<code>chf_register_acf_fields</code>	Register ACF field groups
<code>after_switch_theme</code>	custom-post-types.php	<code>chf_flush_rewrites</code>	Flush on activation
<code>send_headers</code>	security.php	<code>chf_security_headers</code>	HTTP security headers
<code>init</code>	security.php	<code>chf_disable_xmlrpc</code>	Disable XML-RPC
<code>wp_head</code>	security.php	<code>chf_remove_version</code>	Strip generator tag
<code>elementor/elements/categories_registered</code>	elementor-setup.php	<code>chf_add_widget_category</code>	Add "CHF Widgets" category
<code>elementor/dynamic_tags/register</code>	elementor-setup.php	<code>chf_register_dynamic_tags</code>	Register the 4 dynamic tags
<code>elementor/theme/register_locations</code>	elementor-setup.php	<code>chf_register_elementor_locations</code>	Enable Theme Builder locations
<code>after_switch_theme</code>	elementor-setup.php	<code>chf_set_elementor_defaults</code>	Global colors/fonts on activation

4. ACF field API

Reading Hero fields

```
// In a template file or Elementor shortcode
$eyebrow      = get_field( 'hero_eyebrow' );
$highlight    = get_field( 'hero_highlight_word' );
$subtitle     = get_field( 'hero_subtitle' );
$bg_image     = get_field( 'hero_background_image' ); // returns array

if ( $bg_image ) {
    $url = $bg_image['url'];
    $alt = $bg_image['alt'];
}
```

Reading Event fields

```
$date      = get_field( 'event_date' );          // Ymd string
$time      = get_field( 'event_time' );          // e.g., "6:00 PM - 9:00 PM CST"
$location  = get_field( 'event_location' );
$reg_url   = get_field( 'event_registration_url' );

// Format the date
$date_obj = DateTime::createFromFormat( 'Ymd', $date );
$formatted = $date_obj ? $date_obj->format( 'F j, Y' ) : '';
```

Programmatically updating ACF fields

```
update_field( 'hero_eyebrow', 'NEW VALUE', $post_id );
update_field( 'event_date', '20260615', $post_id ); // Ymd format
```

Field group locations

Defined in `inc/custom-post-types.php` via `acf_add_local_field_group()`. Do NOT re-create these in the ACF admin UI — that will create duplicates and precedence conflicts.

To add a new field group, add another `acf_add_local_field_group()` call in that file, following the same pattern.

5. Adding a new Custom Post Type

Use this pattern in `inc/custom-post-types.php`:

```

/**
 * Register the "CHF Report" custom post type.
 */
function chf_register_report_cpt() {
    $labels = array(
        'name'          => _x( 'Reports', 'post type general name', 'chf' ),
        'singular_name' => _x( 'Report', 'post type singular name', 'chf' ),
        'menu_name'     => __( 'Reports', 'chf' ),
        'add_new_item'  => __( 'Add New Report', 'chf' ),
        'edit_item'     => __( 'Edit Report', 'chf' ),
        'view_item'     => __( 'View Report', 'chf' ),
        'search_items'  => __( 'Search Reports', 'chf' ),
    );

    $args = array(
        'labels'          => $labels,
        'public'          => true,
        'has_archive'     => 'reports',
        'rewrite'         => array( 'slug' => 'report', 'with_front' => false ),
        'supports'        => array( 'title', 'editor', 'thumbnail', 'excerpt', 'revisions', 'custom-fields' ),
        'menu_icon'       => 'dashicons-media-document',
        'show_in_rest'    => true,
        'menu_position'   => 25,
        'show_in_nav_menus' => true,
        'exclude_from_search' => false,
    );

    register_post_type( 'chf_report', $args );
}
add_action( 'init', 'chf_register_report_cpt' );

```

After adding any new post type: 1. Visit Settings → Permalinks → Save Changes (to flush rewrite rules) 2. Add an Elementor Theme Builder template for the single post view 3. Set display conditions on that template

6. Adding a new ACF field group

```
function chf_register_report_fields() {
    if ( ! function_exists( 'acf_add_local_field_group' ) ) {
        return;
    }

    acf_add_local_field_group( array(
        'key'      => 'group_chf_report',
        'title'    => 'Report Details',
        'fields'   => array(
            array(
                'key'      => 'field_chf_report_year',
                'label'    => 'Report Year',
                'name'     => 'report_year',
                'type'     => 'number',
                'min'      => 2020,
                'max'      => 2050,
            ),
            array(
                'key'      => 'field_chf_report_pdf',
                'label'    => 'Report PDF',
                'name'     => 'report_pdf',
                'type'     => 'file',
                'return_format' => 'array',
                'mime_types' => 'pdf',
            ),
        ),
        'location' => array(
            array(
                array(
                    'param'    => 'post_type',
                    'operator' => '==',
                    'value'    => 'chf_report',
                ),
            ),
        ),
    ));

    add_action( 'acf/init', 'chf_register_report_fields' );
}
```

7. Adding a new Elementor Dynamic Tag

To expose any ACF field as a dynamic source in the Elementor editor:

```

function chf_register_report_dynamic_tag( $dynamic_tags_manager ) {

    $dynamic_tags_manager->register_group( 'chf-fields', array(
        'title' => __( 'CHF Fields', 'chf' ),
    ) );

    if ( ! class_exists( 'CHF_Report_Year_Tag' ) ) :
    class CHF_Report_Year_Tag extends \Elementor\Core\DynamicTags\Tag {

        public function get_name() {
            return 'chf-report-year';
        }

        public function get_title() {
            return __( 'Report Year', 'chf' );
        }

        public function get_group() {
            return 'chf-fields';
        }

        public function get_categories() {
            return array( \Elementor\Modules\DynamicTags\Module::TEXT_CATEGORY );
        }

        public function render() {
            $year = function_exists( 'get_field' ) ? get_field( 'report_year' ) : '';
            echo esc_html( $year );
        }
    }
    endif;

    $dynamic_tags_manager->register( new CHF_Report_Year_Tag() );
}
add_action( 'elementor/dynamic_tags/register', 'chf_register_report_dynamic_tag' );

```

8. Adding a new stylesheet

If you need a stylesheet that only loads on certain pages:

```

function chf_conditional_styles() {
    if ( is_singular( 'chf_report' ) ) {
        wp_enqueue_style(
            'chf-report',
            get_stylesheet_directory_uri() . '/assets/css/report.css',
            array( 'chf-design-system' ),
            CHF_VERSION
        );
    }
}
add_action( 'wp_enqueue_scripts', 'chf_conditional_styles' );

```

Always declare dependencies (`array( 'chf-design-system' )`) so WordPress loads them in the right order.

9. Adding a widget to the "CHF Widgets" category

If you create a custom Elementor widget, add it to the CHF group for easy finding in the editor panel:

```
class My_Custom_Widget extends \Elementor\Widget_Base {

    public function get_categories() {
        return array( 'chf-widgets' );
    }

    // ... rest of widget
}
```

10. Database queries

Always use `wpdb` with prepared statements

```
global $wpdb;

// ❌ WRONG - SQL injection risk
$results = $wpdb->get_results( "SELECT * FROM wp_posts WHERE ID = $id" );

// ✅ RIGHT
$results = $wpdb->get_results( $wpdb->prepare(
    "SELECT * FROM {$wpdb->posts} WHERE ID = %d",
    $id
) );
```

Use `WP_Query` , not raw SQL

```
$query = new WP_Query( array(
    'post_type'      => 'chf_event',
    'posts_per_page' => 6,
    'meta_key'       => 'event_date',
    'orderby'        => 'meta_value',
    'order'          => 'ASC',
    'meta_query'     => array(
        array(
            'key'     => 'event_date',
            'value'   => date( 'Ymd' ),
            'compare' => '>=',
        ),
    ),
) );
```

Never forget `wp_reset_postdata()`

```
if ( $query->have_posts() ) {
    while ( $query->have_posts() ) {
        $query->the_post();
        // render
    }
    wp_reset_postdata(); // ← always
}
```

11. Debugging tools

Query Monitor

Install during development. Shows: - All SQL queries per page - Hooks that ran - HTTP requests made - Memory usage - Deprecated function calls

Activate only on staging — it's heavy for production.

Debug Bar + extensions

Lighter than Query Monitor. Shows hooks, queries, cache, and constants.

Xdebug

If running with Docker/Local, enable Xdebug for step-through debugging in VS Code or PhpStorm. Worth the 20 minutes of setup.

Error logs

Always check your `debug.log` before guessing at errors. Enable via:

```
define('WP_DEBUG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_LOG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY', false);
```

Log lives at `wp-content/debug.log`.

12. Git workflow

The theme is versioned. Recommended workflow:

Branches

- `main` — production, always deployable
- `develop` — integration branch
- `feature/xyz` — new work
- `fix/xyz` — bug fixes
- `hotfix/xyz` — emergency production fixes

Commit message format

Follow Conventional Commits:

```
feat: add report CPT with ACF fields
fix: correct hero subtitle dynamic tag fallback
docs: update install guide slug mapping
refactor: consolidate counter selector
chore: bump theme version to 5.1.0
```

Before committing

- [] Run `php -l` on changed PHP files (syntax check)
- [] Validate any JSON you edited with `jq`
- [] Test on local staging
- [] Update version in `style.css` for meaningful changes
- [] Document new hooks in this file

Before deploying to production

- [] Full regression test on staging
- [] Database backup
- [] Files backup
- [] Deploy during low-traffic window
- [] Smoke test immediately after

13. Performance profiling

Page speed

```
# Run Lighthouse CLI from terminal
npm install -g lighthouse
lighthouse https://yoursite.com --view
```

Database queries

Enable Query Monitor, load a slow page, inspect the queries panel. Look for: - Duplicate queries (N+1 problem) - Queries > 100ms - Missing indexes

PHP profiling

Use Xdebug or Blackfire.io. Profile the slowest page, look for: - Function calls taking > 50ms - Memory spikes - Unnecessary database calls in loops

14. Release checklist

When cutting a new theme release:

- [] Update `CHF_VERSION` constant in `functions.php`
- [] Update `Version:` header in `style.css`
- [] Update this docs packet if needed
- [] Tag the git commit: `git tag v5.1.0 && git push --tags`
- [] Create a zip of the theme: `zip -r chf-theme-v5.1.0.zip chf-theme/`
- [] Upload zip to client's private asset storage
- [] Notify client of the release + changelog

- [] Deploy to staging → test → deploy to production

15. Useful code snippets

Fetch upcoming events only

```
$upcoming = new WP_Query( array(
    'post_type'      => 'chf_event',
    'posts_per_page' => -1,
    'meta_key'       => 'event_date',
    'orderby'        => 'meta_value',
    'order'          => 'ASC',
    'meta_query'     => array(
        array(
            'key'      => 'event_date',
            'value'    => date( 'Ymd' ),
            'compare'  => '>=',
        ),
    ),
) );
```

Get initiatives by category

```
$energy = new WP_Query( array(
    'post_type'      => 'chf_initiative',
    'tax_query'      => array(
        array(
            'taxonomy' => 'initiative_category',
            'field'    => 'slug',
            'terms'    => 'energy-climate',
        ),
    ),
) );
```

Add body class for Elementor pages

```
function chf_add_body_classes( $classes ) {
    if ( class_exists( 'Elementor\Plugin' ) ) {
        $document = \Elementor\Plugin::$instance->documents->get( get_the_ID() );
        if ( $document && $document->is_built_with_elementor() ) {
            $classes[] = 'chf-elementor-page';
        }
    }
    return $classes;
}
add_filter( 'body_class', 'chf_add_body_classes' );
```

Conditional enqueue only on homepage

```
function chf_homepage_styles() {  
    if ( is_front_page() ) {  
        wp_enqueue_style(  
            'CHF-homepage',  
            get_stylesheet_directory_uri() . '/assets/css/homepage.css',  
            array(),  
            CHF_VERSION  
        );  
    }  
}  
add_action( 'wp_enqueue_scripts', 'CHF_homepage_styles' );
```

16. Known issues / technical debt

None currently. The v5.0.0 QA audit cleared all identified issues. If you find new issues, document them here.

Maintenance

MAINTENANCE.md

Keeping the CHF website healthy, fast, and secure. Every task in this guide is scheduled — follow the rhythm and you'll avoid 95% of problems.

1. Maintenance calendar

Weekly (≈15 minutes)

- ☐ Check uptime alerts (should be 99.9%+)
- ☐ Review Wordfence activity log for blocked attacks
- ☐ Check pending WordPress + plugin updates
- ☐ Review form submissions (Elementor → Submissions)
- ☐ Check broken links (Yoast → Tools → Text Link Counter or a scan tool)

Monthly (≈1 hour)

- ☐ Apply safe WordPress core updates
- ☐ Apply safe plugin updates (Elementor Pro, ACF Pro, Yoast, Wordfence)
- ☐ Run a Wordfence full scan
- ☐ Check Google Search Console for coverage errors
- ☐ Check Google Analytics for traffic anomalies
- ☐ Review and approve comment queue (if comments enabled)
- ☐ Verify backups are running and restorable
- ☐ Check database size (Tools → Site Health → Info → Database)

Quarterly (≈2 hours)

- ☐ Review and clean Media Library (remove unused uploads)
- ☐ Optimize database (Advanced Database Cleaner or WP-Optimize)
- ☐ Test disaster-recovery restore from a backup
- ☐ Audit user accounts — remove unused, update roles
- ☐ Review and update SSL certificate if not auto-renewed
- ☐ Check page speed (PageSpeed Insights, GTmetrix)
- ☐ Run accessibility scan (WAVE tool or axe DevTools)
- ☐ Review Google Search Console queries + CTR

Annually (≈4 hours)

- ☐ Major WordPress version upgrade (if not done incrementally)
- ☐ PHP version upgrade test (on staging first)
- ☐ Hosting plan review — are you on the right tier?

- ☐ Domain renewal check
 - ☐ Privacy policy and terms review
 - ☐ Full security audit (or pay for external audit)
 - ☐ Update this documentation packet if anything has changed
-

2. Updates — how to apply safely

Never update on Friday afternoon. If something breaks, you want to be at a computer with time to fix it.

Safe order

1. Back up first (see § 3)
2. Update plugins one at a time
3. Check the site works after each
4. Update WordPress core last
5. Update themes last (or never — CHF theme rarely needs updates)

Update checklist after every update

- ☐ Load the homepage — does it look right?
- ☐ Load 2–3 interior pages
- ☐ Load an initiative and event single page
- ☐ Open a page in Elementor — does it open cleanly?
- ☐ Submit the newsletter form — does it still work?
- ☐ Check admin dashboard for new error notices
- ☐ Run **Tools → Site Health** — any new issues?

If an update breaks something

Option A — Roll back the plugin (fastest): 1. Install **WP Rollback** plugin (free) 2. **Plugins → Installed Plugins** → find the broken one → **Rollback** 3. Pick the previous version

Option B — Restore from backup: 1. If using UpdraftPlus: **Settings → UpdraftPlus → Restore** → pick most recent backup
2. If using host-managed backups: log into host panel → Backups → Restore

3. Backups

Backup strategy — follow the 3-2-1 rule

- **3** copies of your data
- **2** different storage types (host + cloud)
- **1** offsite (not in the same data center)

Recommended setup

Primary: host-managed daily backups - WP Engine, Kinsta, Pressable include this automatically - Retention: 30 days minimum

Secondary: UpdraftPlus → Dropbox or Google Drive - Free plugin, pro version adds more destinations - Settings: - Files backup: weekly → Dropbox - Database backup: daily → Dropbox - Retention: 14 days

Alternative: BackupBuddy or BlogVault — paid, more powerful

What to back up

- WordPress database (`wp_*` tables)
- `wp-content/uploads/` (all your images)
- `wp-content/themes/chf-theme/` (the theme)
- `wp-content/plugins/` (all plugin folders)
- `wp-config.php` (site config)
- `.htaccess` (Apache rules)

Test your backups

A backup you've never restored is not a backup.

Every quarter: 1. Spin up a staging environment (most hosts offer this) 2. Import your backup 3. Verify the site loads and content is present 4. Delete the staging environment

4. Security response

If Wordfence alerts you about an attack

1. Log into WordPress immediately
2. **Wordfence → Firewall → Live Traffic** to see what's happening
3. Block the attacking IP range if needed
4. If the attacker got in (unlikely with Wordfence blocking): restore from backup immediately, change all passwords, scan for malware

If you get a "site hacked" warning from Google Search Console

1. **DO NOT** panic and reinstall WordPress blindly
2. Take the site offline (or enable maintenance mode)
3. Check **wp-content/uploads/** for recent PHP files (these should not exist)
4. Check **wp-content/plugins/** for unfamiliar plugins
5. Restore from the most recent backup **before** the infection
6. Change all passwords (WordPress admin, database, hosting, FTP)
7. Scan with Wordfence full scan → Remove any infected files
8. Request review in Google Search Console → Security Issues → Request Review
9. Once clean, enable 2FA for all admin users

Password rules

- Minimum 16 characters
- Unique per service (use a password manager — 1Password, Bitwarden)
- Change every 90 days for admin accounts
- Never reuse an email address as a username
- Disable the `admin` username (create a new admin, delete `admin`)

Strongly recommended

- **Two-factor authentication** via Wordfence or a dedicated 2FA plugin
- **Limit Login Attempts Reloaded** plugin — blocks after 3 failed attempts
- **Activity log** plugin (WP Activity Log) — records every admin action

5. Performance

Measure first, optimize second

Use these tools monthly to catch regressions:

Tool	URL	What it tells you
PageSpeed Insights	pagespeed.web.dev	Core Web Vitals, LCP, CLS, FID
GTmetrix	gtmetrix.com	Page load waterfall, asset sizes
WebPageTest	webpagetest.org	Real-device simulation

Target scores: - PageSpeed mobile: 85+ - PageSpeed desktop: 95+ - LCP: under 2.5s - CLS: under 0.1

Common performance fixes

Problem: LCP over 4 seconds - Compress the hero image (it's the largest element) - Use WebP format instead of JPG - Add `loading="eager"` to the hero image (not lazy) - Enable Cloudflare or similar CDN

Problem: CLS over 0.1 - Add width + height to every image - Reserve space for dynamic content (ads, embeds) - Avoid inserting elements above existing content

Problem: Huge CSS bundle - Elementor → Settings → Features → enable **Improved CSS Loading** - Make sure experimental **Optimized CSS Loading** is on

Problem: JavaScript execution slow - Defer all third-party scripts - Remove unused plugins - Disable Elementor motion effects if overused

Caching strategy

Level 1 — Page cache (hosted): - Most managed hosts (Kinsta, WP Engine, Pressable) include this - If on shared hosting, install **WP Super Cache** (free, reliable) - **Do not use W3 Total Cache or WP Rocket unless you test Elementor compatibility carefully**

Level 2 — Object cache: - Redis preferred, Memcached acceptable - Requires hosting support — ask your host to enable it

Level 3 — CDN: - Cloudflare free tier is sufficient - Configure: Auto Minify ON, Brotli ON, Rocket Loader OFF (breaks Elementor)

Level 4 — Browser cache: - Host should set far-future expiry on `/wp-content/uploads/*` and `/wp-content/themes/*.css` - If not, add to `.htaccess`: `apache <IfModule mod_expires.c> ExpiresActive On ExpiresByType image/jpg "access plus 1 year" ExpiresByType image/webp "access plus 1 year" ExpiresByType text/css "access plus 1 month" ExpiresByType application/javascript "access plus 1 month" </IfModule>`

6. Database maintenance

Over time, the WordPress database accumulates: - Post revisions (one per save — thousands over a year) - Spam comments - Transient options - Orphaned postmeta

Monthly cleanup

1. Install **WP-Optimize** or **Advanced Database Cleaner** (free)
2. Run "Clean database" on:
3. Post revisions older than 30 days
4. Spam comments
5. Trashed items
6. Expired transients
7. Orphaned postmeta

Limit post revisions

Add to `wp-config.php`:

```
define('WP_POST_REVISIONS', 10);
```

Keeps the last 10 only. Default is unlimited.

Database table monitoring

Tools → Site Health → Info → Database shows: - Total size - Table sizes

A healthy CHF site DB should be **under 100 MB**. If it crosses 500 MB, something is wrong (usually a plugin logging too aggressively, or post revisions not being limited).

7. SEO maintenance

Monthly

- [] Check Google Search Console → Performance → top queries (what's ranking?)
- [] Check Search Console → Coverage → any errors?
- [] Check Search Console → Core Web Vitals → any failing URLs?

Quarterly

- [] Review Yoast SEO analysis on top 10 pages
- [] Update meta descriptions if CTR is low
- [] Submit new content URLs to Search Console for indexing

Annually

- [] Full content audit — what's outdated?
- [] Broken link scan (Screaming Frog or Yoast)
- [] Review schema markup (Yoast handles this automatically for most)

8. Monitoring setup

Uptime monitoring

Free options: - UptimeRobot (50 monitors free) - Better Uptime (10 monitors free)

Monitor every 5 minutes from multiple locations. Set SMS + email alerts.

Error monitoring

WordPress debug logs: enable in `wp-config.php` during troubleshooting only:

```
define('WP_DEBUG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_LOG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY', false);
```

Logs to `wp-content/debug.log`. Turn off in production once done.

For ongoing PHP error monitoring, use a service like: - Bugsnag - Sentry - NewRelic

Analytics

Google Analytics 4 — install via Yoast or a dedicated plugin. Don't use client-side analytics in a way that requires cookie consent banners unless you actually need user-level tracking.

Privacy-respecting alternatives: - Plausible - Fathom - Simple Analytics

9. Plugin policy

Required plugins (do not deactivate)

- **Elementor Pro** — page builder, site depends on it
- **Advanced Custom Fields Pro** — dynamic fields
- **Yoast SEO** — meta, schema, sitemap
- **Wordfence** — security firewall and scanner

Strongly recommended

- **UpdraftPlus** — offsite backups
- **Redirection** — manage URL redirects (especially post-launch)
- **WP Rollback** — revert plugin updates

Optional based on need

- **WP Mail SMTP** — if transactional emails don't deliver
- **WP-Optimize** or **Advanced Database Cleaner** — monthly DB cleanup
- **Loco Translate** — if translating content

Never install

- Multiple caching plugins (pick one)
- Multiple SEO plugins (pick one — Yoast here)
- Multiple security plugins (pick one — Wordfence here)
- **Any plugin not updated in the last 12 months** (abandonware is a risk)
- Plugins from unknown developers (check the WordPress.org plugin page)

Before installing any new plugin

1. Check last updated date (within 6 months)
2. Check active installs (over 10,000 is safer)
3. Check support forum (recent resolutions?)
4. Install on staging first
5. Test for 3 days before moving to production

10. Hosting notes

Minimum hosting requirements

- PHP 8.2+
- MySQL 5.7+ or MariaDB 10.3+
- 2 GB RAM
- 20 GB disk
- SSL included
- Daily backups
- Staging environment
- SSH access

Recommended hosts

Tier	Host	Monthly
Budget	SiteGround GrowBig	\$10–20
Mid	Kinsta Starter	\$35
Premium	WP Engine Professional	\$50+

Avoid: GoDaddy managed WordPress (slow), Bluehost (overloaded shared servers), any \$3/month host.

Server config — what to ask your host for

- `memory_limit = 256M`
- `max_execution_time = 300`
- `post_max_size = 64M`
- `upload_max_filesize = 64M`
- `max_input_vars = 5000` (Elementor needs this)
- `max_allowed_packet = 64M` (MySQL)
- OPcache enabled
- Redis or Memcached object cache

11. Contact + escalation

When something is beyond routine maintenance:

1. **First:** consult [TROUBLESHOOTING.md](#)
2. **If still stuck:** contact your web vendor (see CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md for contact info)
3. **Elementor issues:** Elementor Pro includes premium support — elementor.com/support
4. **Host issues:** support ticket via hosting panel
5. **Security incidents:** Wordfence Response (paid plan) or independent security audit

Troubleshooting

TROUBLESHOOTING.md

Symptom → cause → fix. Start at the symptom that matches your problem and work down.

Quick diagnostic checklist

When something is wrong, run through this before anything else:

1. ☐ Can you reproduce it on a different browser? (Chrome → Firefox)
 2. ☐ Can you reproduce it in incognito mode? (rules out browser cache/extensions)
 3. ☐ Can you reproduce it on mobile? (rules out device-specific issues)
 4. ☐ What was the last change made to the site? (updates, new plugin, edit)
 5. ☐ Is there an error message? Write it down verbatim.
-

1. White screen of death (WSoD)

Symptom

Blank white page instead of the site. Sometimes on frontend only, sometimes admin too.

Cause

PHP fatal error. Something is throwing an exception that kills the whole WordPress bootstrap.

Fix

Step 1 — enable debug mode (via FTP / cPanel File Manager):

Edit `wp-config.php`, add before `/* That's all, stop editing! */`:

```
define('WP_DEBUG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_LOG', true);
define('WP_DEBUG_DISPLAY', false);
```

Step 2 — trigger the error again, then check `/wp-content/debug.log`. The last line is your error. It'll look like:

```
PHP Fatal error: Uncaught Error: Call to undefined function xyz() in /path/file.php:123
```

Step 3 — based on the file path in the error:

File path	Cause	Fix
/wp-content/plugins/[NAME]/	Plugin crashed	Rename plugin folder to disable: [NAME].disabled
/wp-content/themes/chf-theme/	Theme code issue	Revert recent theme changes or activate a default theme temporarily
/wp-content/themes/hello-elementor/	Parent theme update broke	Roll back Hello Elementor via WP Rollback
/wp-includes/	WordPress core issue	Re-upload WordPress core files via FTP

Step 4 — turn off debug mode once fixed:

```
define('WP_DEBUG', false);
```

2. "Database connection error"

Symptom

Red error box: **"Error establishing a database connection"**

Cause

WordPress can't talk to MySQL. Could be credentials, server down, or corrupted tables.

Fix

Check 1 — credentials in wp-config.php :

```
define( 'DB_NAME', 'database_name_here' );
define( 'DB_USER', 'username_here' );
define( 'DB_PASSWORD', 'password_here' );
define( 'DB_HOST', 'localhost' ); // sometimes IP or domain
```

Verify these match what your host provides. Credentials often change after a migration.

Check 2 — MySQL server is up: In your hosting panel (cPanel, Plesk, Kinsta, etc.), check if the MySQL service is running. If down, restart it or contact support.

Check 3 — repair the database: Add to wp-config.php temporarily:

```
define('WP_ALLOW_REPAIR', true);
```

Then visit yoursite.com/wp-admin/maint/repair.php → click **Repair Database**. Remove the line when done.

3. "Briefly unavailable for scheduled maintenance"

Symptom

Maintenance mode message stuck after a failed update.

Cause

A plugin or core update crashed partway through. WordPress created a `.maintenance` file and never removed it.

Fix

FTP/SFTP into the site root, delete `.maintenance`. Site comes back.

```
/
├── .maintenance  ← delete this file
├── wp-admin/
├── wp-content/
└── wp-config.php
```

4. Changes don't appear on the live site

Symptom

You edit a page, click Update, the editor says saved, but visitors see the old version.

Cause

Caching. Somewhere in the stack, something is serving a stale copy.

Fix (in order)

1. **Browser hard refresh:** Cmd+Shift+R (Mac) or Ctrl+Shift+F5 (Windows)
2. **Clear WordPress page cache:**
 3. WP Super Cache → Delete Cache
 4. WP Rocket → Clear Cache
 5. Host panel → Purge server cache (Kinsta, WP Engine have this)
6. **Clear Elementor CSS cache:** Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data
7. **Clear CDN cache:**
 8. Cloudflare → Caching → Purge Everything
9. **Check Object Cache:**
 10. If using Redis: host panel → flush Redis
11. **Check your DNS:** `dig yoursite.com` — is it pointing where you think?

Still stale? Add `?debug=1` to the URL. WordPress will bypass most caches. If that works, the cache is the culprit.

5. Elementor editor won't load

Symptom

Blue loading bar, then nothing. Blank grey area. Or "Preview could not be loaded."

Fix

1. **Reload the page** and wait 30 seconds before giving up
2. **Deactivate recently added plugins** — any one can break Elementor
3. **Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data**
4. **Elementor → Tools → Safe Mode** → reload → does it work?
5. If yes: a plugin is interfering, find it by deactivating one at a time
6. If no: theme or core WordPress issue
7. **Check `memory_limit`** — needs 256M minimum. Add to `wp-config.php`: `php define('WP_MEMORY_LIMIT', '256M');`
8. **Check PHP version** — must be 8.0+ for Elementor 3.x
9. **Check for console errors** — F12 → Console tab in browser. JavaScript errors tell you exactly what's broken.
10. **Re-upload Elementor Pro** — in your Elementor account, download the zip, then Plugins → Add New → Upload → overwrite

6. Form submissions not arriving

Symptom

User submits the newsletter or contact form. You never receive the email.

Cause

WordPress uses `wp_mail()` which uses PHP `mail()` by default. Shared hosts often silently drop these.

Fix

Step 1 — check Elementor submissions log: **Elementor → Submissions** — is the submission there? If yes, the form worked. The problem is email delivery.

Step 2 — install WP Mail SMTP: 1. **Plugins → Add New** → search "WP Mail SMTP" 2. Install and activate 3. Configure with SMTP credentials: - SendGrid (free 100/day) - Amazon SES (cheap, reliable) - Postmark (premium, fastest) 4. Send a test email from WP Mail SMTP → Tools → Email Test 5. Check spam folder if not in inbox

Step 3 — verify Elementor email action: 1. Edit the form in Elementor 2. **Actions After Submit** → should include "Email" 3. **Email** → recipient address, subject, body — verify they're correct 4. Enable **Email 2** as a backup recipient if needed

7. Images not uploading

Symptom

Upload fails, "HTTP error", or "Post-processing of the image failed."

Fix

Check 1 — file size: - Max upload size is visible in Media → Add New - If too low, increase in `php.ini` or `.htaccess : ini`
`upload_max_filesize = 64M post_max_size = 64M memory_limit = 256M`

Check 2 — file permissions: - `wp-content/uploads/` must be writable (755 or 775) - Via FTP: right-click uploads folder → Permissions → 755 → apply recursively

Check 3 — disk space: - Hosting panel → check disk quota - Run out of space? Delete old backups, clear media library, remove dev files

Check 4 — image dimensions too large: - Images over 4000px on either side sometimes fail - Resize before upload (Photoshop, Preview, ImageOptim)

Check 5 — GD or Imagick library: - Tools → Site Health → Info → Media Handling - Must show "GD" or "ImageMagick" available - If neither: ask host to install ImageMagick

8. 404 errors on new pages

Symptom

New page or post returns "Not Found" even though it exists.

Cause

WordPress rewrite rules are stale.

Fix

Settings → Permalinks → Save Changes

This rebuilds the `.htaccess` rewrite rules. No actual setting needs to change — just clicking Save fixes it.

Still 404? Check: - Is the page status Published (not Draft)? - Is there a typo in the URL? - Is there a conflicting page/post with the same slug?

9. Hero fields not showing

Symptom

You filled in Eyebrow / Highlight / Subtitle in the WordPress editor, but they don't appear on the page.

Cause

The Elementor template for that page doesn't reference the dynamic fields, OR the page cache is stale, OR ACF is not active.

Fix

1. **Check ACF Pro is activated** (Plugins → Installed Plugins)
2. **Re-save the page** — sometimes ACF fields don't fire without a save
3. **Clear all caches** (see § 4)

4. **Edit the page template in Elementor:**
 5. Open the page with "Edit with Elementor"
 6. Find the hero heading/text widgets
 7. Click the database icon next to each text field
 8. Verify it uses "CHF Hero Eyebrow" / "CHF Hero Subtitle" dynamic tag
 9. If not, switch to dynamic
 10. **Verify ACF field group assignment:**
 11. Custom Fields → Field Groups → Hero Fields
 12. Location rules should include the post type (page, initiative, event, post)
-

10. Newsletter form styling broken

Symptom

Newsletter signup form renders but styling is wrong (no button color, wrong font).

Cause

`elementor-overrides.css` is not loading, OR the form widget was edited outside the brand template.

Fix

1. **Check stylesheet loads:**
 2. View page source → Ctrl+F → search `elementor-overrides.css`
 3. Should be there. If missing, check `functions.php` enqueue block
 4. **Regenerate Elementor CSS:**
 5. Elementor → Tools → Regenerate CSS & Data
 6. **Re-import the newsletter template:**
 7. Templates → Saved Templates → Delete existing CHF Newsletter Section
 8. Templates → Import → `elementor-templates/section-newsletter.json`
 9. **Re-link global color/font:**
 10. Open the form widget, re-assign Global Color to "Green" for the button
-

11. Login locked out

Symptom

Too many failed login attempts, now blocked from `/wp-admin/`.

Cause

Wordfence or Limit Login Attempts blocked your IP.

Fix

Option A — from another IP: - Try logging in from phone (off wifi, on cellular) - Works? Unblock your office IP in Wordfence → Firewall → Blocked IPs

Option B — whitelist your IP via `wp-config.php`: Via FTP, edit `wp-config.php`, add:

```
define('WORDFENCE_DISABLE_IP_BLOCKING', true);
```

Log in, unblock the IP, remove the line.

Option C — via database: Via phpMyAdmin, delete rows from `wp_wflocked_out_ips` matching your IP.

12. SSL certificate error / "Not Secure"

Symptom

Browser shows "Not Secure" warning, or HTTPS is broken.

Fix

1. **Check if SSL is installed:**
 2. `https://yoursite.com` should load without warnings
 3. If not, SSL not installed — ask host to install Let's Encrypt (free)
 4. **Check WordPress address:**
 5. Settings → General → both URLs must start with `https://`
 6. If not, change them (careful — can lock you out; back up first)
 7. **Mixed content warnings:**
 8. Some assets load over HTTP, triggering the warning
 9. Install **Really Simple SSL** plugin → it auto-rewrites URLs
 10. **Check certificate expiry:**
 11. `https://www.ssllabs.com/ssltest/` → enter your domain
 12. Should show valid cert with recent expiry
 13. **HSTS cache:**
 14. If you had HTTPS then reverted, HSTS blocks HTTP
 15. Browser → clear HSTS for the domain (Chrome: `chrome://net-internals/#hsts`)
-

13. Search shows wrong results

Symptom

WordPress search returns irrelevant or no results.

Cause

Default WordPress search is weak. It only searches title + content, ignores CPTs sometimes.

Fix

1. **Include custom post types in search** — add to `functions.php`:

```
php function chf_include_cpt_in_search($query) { if ($query->is_search && !is_admin()) { $query->set('post_type', ['post', 'page', 'chf_initiative', 'chf_event']); } } add_action('pre_get_posts', 'chf_include_cpt_in_search');
```
 2. **Better search plugins:**
 3. **Relevanssi** — full-text relevance search
 4. **SearchWP** (paid) — more configurable
 5. **Algolia or MeiliSearch** for enterprise-quality search
-

14. PHP version incompatibility

Symptom

"Your site requires PHP 8.2 or higher" or deprecation warnings.

Fix

1. **Check current PHP version:**
 2. Tools → Site Health → Info → Server
 3. **Upgrade PHP via hosting panel:**
 4. cPanel → MultiPHP Manager → select 8.2
 5. Kinsta/WP Engine → settings → PHP version → 8.2
 6. **Test first on staging:**
 7. Some old plugins may not support PHP 8.2
 8. Upgrade one environment, test, then promote to production
-

15. When all else fails — restore from backup

If you can't figure out what's wrong and the site is actively broken:

1. **Identify the last known good backup** (time-stamped)
 2. **Back up the current broken state** (in case you need forensics later)
 3. **Restore the good backup:**
 4. UpdraftPlus: **Settings → UpdraftPlus → Existing Backups → Restore**
 5. Host-managed: via hosting panel
 6. **Verify the site loads correctly**
 7. **Don't repeat whatever broke it** until you know what it was
 8. **Investigate on staging** before re-attempting
-

Emergency contact escalation

Problem	First contact	If no response within
Site down	Hosting support	1 hour
Hacked	Wordfence Response OR your vendor	30 minutes
Domain expired	Registrar support	4 hours
SSL expired	Hosting support	4 hours
DNS misconfigured	DNS provider support	2 hours
Can't reach vendor	Second opinion — post on Elementor support forum or r/WordPress	24 hours

Launch Checklist

LAUNCH-CHECKLIST.md

Every item here must be checked off before going live. Launch is a one-way door — invest the hour going through this list.

T minus 2 weeks

Hosting & domain

- ☐ Production hosting account active
- ☐ PHP 8.2+ verified
- ☐ MySQL 5.7+ verified
- ☐ SSL certificate installed (Let's Encrypt or host-provided)
- ☐ Domain registrar access confirmed
- ☐ DNS management access confirmed
- ☐ Email / MX records planned (Google Workspace? Microsoft 365?)
- ☐ Backup strategy in place (UpdraftPlus + host-managed)

Staging

- ☐ Staging environment running
- ☐ Full site built on staging
- ☐ Content imported and verified
- ☐ Elementor templates imported with correct conditions
- ☐ All 46 content items present and linked correctly
- ☐ Featured images uploaded and assigned

Stakeholders

- ☐ Client has reviewed staging site
 - ☐ Client has signed off on content
 - ☐ Client has signed off on design
 - ☐ Legal has reviewed privacy policy + terms
 - ☐ Launch date confirmed in writing
-

T minus 1 week

Content QA

- ☐ Proofread every page (typos, broken sentences)
- ☐ Verify all links work (use Screaming Frog or Dr. Link Check)

- ☐ Verify all images display correctly
- ☐ Verify all images have alt text
- ☐ Verify all forms submit successfully
- ☐ Check phone numbers are correct
- ☐ Check email addresses are correct
- ☐ Check all social media links
- ☐ Verify footer year is current
- ☐ Verify copyright line is correct

SEO

- ☐ Every page has a unique meta title (Yoast)
- ☐ Every page has a unique meta description (Yoast)
- ☐ Focus keyphrase set for key pages
- ☐ Open Graph images set on homepage + key pages
- ☐ Schema markup verified (rich results test)
- ☐ XML sitemap accessible at `/sitemap_index.xml`
- ☐ `robots.txt` configured correctly (allow all for launch)
- ☐ Google Analytics 4 installed
- ☐ Google Search Console verified
- ☐ Google Tag Manager installed (if applicable)

Performance

- ☐ PageSpeed Insights mobile score 85+
- ☐ PageSpeed Insights desktop score 95+
- ☐ LCP under 2.5s
- ☐ CLS under 0.1
- ☐ All images compressed (max 400 KB hero, 200 KB content)
- ☐ WebP used where supported
- ☐ Fonts preloaded
- ☐ CSS minified (Elementor handles this)
- ☐ JavaScript deferred
- ☐ Caching plugin configured and tested
- ☐ CDN configured (Cloudflare recommended)

Accessibility

- ☐ WAVE accessibility tool — zero errors, max 3 warnings
- ☐ All images have alt text
- ☐ All form fields have labels
- ☐ All buttons have accessible names
- ☐ Color contrast passes WCAG AA (4.5:1 body, 3:1 large)
- ☐ Keyboard navigation works on all interactive elements
- ☐ Focus indicators visible

- ☐ Page has proper heading hierarchy (one H1, no skipped levels)
- ☐ Skip-to-content link works
- ☐ `<html lang="en">` set
- ☐ Screen reader tested (VoiceOver or NVDA) on homepage + 2 interior pages

Security

- ☐ Strong admin password (16+ chars)
- ☐ Default `admin` username removed
- ☐ Two-factor authentication enabled
- ☐ Wordfence activated and scanned
- ☐ XML-RPC disabled (already in CHF theme)
- ☐ File editing disabled (already in CHF theme)
- ☐ HTTPS enforced site-wide
- ☐ HSTS header verified
- ☐ Security headers verified via securityheaders.com
- ☐ `wp-config.php` has unique salts
- ☐ `wp-config.php` is outside web root OR has restrictive permissions
- ☐ Debug mode OFF

Forms & integrations

- ☐ Newsletter form submits successfully
- ☐ Newsletter integration wired up (Mailchimp, HubSpot, etc.)
- ☐ Contact form submits successfully
- ☐ Contact form sends email to right address
- ☐ Email delivery tested from site to external address
- ☐ SMTP configured (WP Mail SMTP + SendGrid/SES/Postmark)
- ☐ reCAPTCHA active on forms
- ☐ Spam protection working (test with a gibberish submission)
- ☐ Google Analytics events firing on form submit

Elementor

- ☐ All Theme Builder conditions set correctly
- ☐ Global header displaying on every page
- ☐ Global footer displaying on every page
- ☐ Single post template on initiatives
- ☐ Single post template on events
- ☐ Archive template on events archive
- ☐ Archive template on news archive
- ☐ No "default WordPress editor" pages remaining

Browser testing

- ☐ Chrome (latest) — desktop + mobile

- ☐ Safari (latest) — desktop + mobile (macOS + iOS)
 - ☐ Firefox (latest) — desktop
 - ☐ Edge (latest) — desktop
 - ☐ iPhone — real device (not just simulator)
 - ☐ Android — real device
 - ☐ iPad — real device
-

T minus 1 day

Final checks

- ☐ Fresh backup taken and verified
- ☐ Content frozen (no more edits until after launch)
- ☐ Staging site matches production plan exactly
- ☐ DNS TTL lowered to 5 minutes (for quick rollback if needed)
- ☐ Launch window scheduled (avoid Friday afternoons)
- ☐ Team available during launch window
- ☐ Rollback plan documented
- ☐ Client notified of exact launch time

Pre-flight smoke test

- ☐ Homepage loads
 - ☐ Navigation works
 - ☐ 3 random interior pages load
 - ☐ 1 initiative loads
 - ☐ 1 event loads
 - ☐ Newsletter form submits
 - ☐ Contact form submits
 - ☐ 404 page appears for a bad URL
 - ☐ Search returns results
-

Launch day (T-o)

Go-live sequence

1. ☐ **Final backup** of staging site (the version going live)
2. ☐ **Update DNS A record / CNAME** to point to production
3. ☐ **Install SSL certificate** on production if not auto-installed
4. ☐ **Verify site loads over HTTPS** at the real domain
5. ☐ **Test the full user journey:**

6. Homepage → about → contact → form submission
7. Homepage → initiatives → single initiative
8. Homepage → events → single event → registration
9. ☐ **Test from a different network** (phone on cellular)
10. ☐ **Test from a different country** via VPN if audience is global
11. ☐ **Submit sitemap to Google Search Console**
12. ☐ **Fetch as Google** via Search Console on 3 pages
13. ☐ **Post launch announcement** if planned

Post-launch within 1 hour

- ☐ Verify Google Analytics is receiving data
- ☐ Verify Wordfence is scanning
- ☐ Verify uptime monitor is live (UptimeRobot, etc.)
- ☐ Check for any console errors on homepage
- ☐ Check server error logs for PHP warnings

Post-launch within 24 hours

- ☐ Google Search Console verified on production domain
- ☐ Yoast sitemap submitted
- ☐ DNS TTL raised back to 1 hour (if lowered earlier)
- ☐ Inform team launch is complete
- ☐ Schedule 7-day post-launch review

T plus 1 week (first review)

Check

- ☐ Uptime: should be 100%
- ☐ Traffic coming in (GA4 realtime)
- ☐ No crawl errors in Search Console
- ☐ Pages indexed (search for `site:yoursite.com` on Google)
- ☐ No spam form submissions (if so, enable/tighten reCAPTCHA)
- ☐ No admin lockouts
- ☐ No security alerts

Follow up

- ☐ Client feedback meeting scheduled
 - ☐ Analytics report sent
 - ☐ Any launch-day issues documented + fixed
 - ☐ Issues log reviewed and closed
-

T plus 1 month

Review

- ☐ Page speed still acceptable
- ☐ No new Search Console errors
- ☐ Top-performing pages identified
- ☐ Low-performing pages identified
- ☐ Form conversion rate analyzed
- ☐ Bounce rate analyzed

Optimize

- ☐ Update meta descriptions on low-CTR pages
- ☐ Improve content on low-performing pages
- ☐ Promote high-value pages via social/email
- ☐ Add new content based on client strategy
- ☐ Handoff to ongoing maintenance schedule (see MAINTENANCE.md)

Rollback plan

If launch goes catastrophically wrong in the first hour:

1. **Revert DNS** to the old site (if it still exists)
2. **Restore from backup** taken immediately before launch
3. **Put maintenance mode** on the new site
4. **Communicate** with stakeholders honestly
5. **Post-mortem** within 48 hours

Preparation for rollback: - Keep the old site running for 7 days after launch - Note the old DNS values before changing them - Save the staging backup somewhere accessible even if the site is down

Common launch-day mistakes

- ❌ Launching Friday afternoon (no one to fix issues over the weekend)
- ❌ Forgetting to set the production environment to `noindex` → `index`
- ❌ Leaving Yoast on "Discourage search engines" (check Settings → Reading)
- ❌ Not testing forms with real email delivery
- ❌ Not verifying SSL before pointing DNS
- ❌ Updating multiple things at once — makes rollback impossible
- ❌ Not documenting what was changed at launch time
- ❌ Celebrating before verifying search indexing

Credentials Template

CREDENTIALS-TEMPLATE.md

⚠ SECURITY WARNING

This is a **template** for recording access credentials. Fill in your actual credentials and store this file **securely** — never commit it to git, never send over unencrypted email, never share in Slack or any chat tool.

Recommended secure storage: - **1Password** (Business or Family plan) — shared vault for the team - **Bitwarden** — free tier works for small teams - **Dashlane** — enterprise plan - **LastPass** — acceptable but has had security issues

Never store in: - Plain text files on a shared drive - Google Docs without password protection - Post-it notes on monitors - Browser's built-in password manager (for sensitive admin access) - Email

How to use this template

1. Copy this file, rename to `CREDENTIALS.md` (not committed to git — already gitignored)
 2. Fill in the values you have
 3. Store the completed file in your password manager as a secure note
 4. Delete the local copy when done
 5. Update whenever credentials change
-

1. Hosting

Primary hosting account

- **Provider:** (e.g., Kinsta, WP Engine, SiteGround)
- **Account email:** _
- **Admin panel URL:** _
- **Username:** _
- **Password:** _ (store in password manager)
- **Two-factor method:** _
- **Support phone/email:** _
- **Account number:** _
- **Plan name:** _
- **Monthly cost:** \$_
- **Renewal date:** _
- **Payment method on file:** _

SSH/SFTP access

- **Host:** _

- **Port:** _ (usually 22 or 2222)
- **Username:** _
- **SSH key location:** _ (e.g., `~/.ssh/id_rsa_client`)
- **Password (if applicable):** _

Database access

- **Host:** _
 - **Database name:** _
 - **Username:** _
 - **Password:** _
 - **phpMyAdmin URL:** _
-

2. Domain

Domain registrar

- **Provider:** *(e.g., Namecheap, GoDaddy, Google Domains)*
- **Registrar URL:** _
- **Account email:** _
- **Username:** _
- **Password:** _
- **Two-factor method:** _
- **Renewal date:** _
- **Auto-renew enabled:** _ (yes/no)
- **WHOIS privacy enabled:** _ (yes/no)

DNS management

- **DNS provider:** *(may differ from registrar, e.g., Cloudflare)*
- **Admin URL:** _
- **Username:** _
- **Password:** _

Nameservers

```
ns1._  
ns2._
```

3. WordPress

Admin accounts

Primary admin - URL: <https://centerforhoustonfuture.org/wp-admin/> - Username: _ - Email: _ - Password: _ - Role: Administrator - 2FA enabled: _

Secondary admin (backup) - Username: _ - Email: _ - Password: _ - Role: Administrator

Editor accounts (content team) - Name → Username → Email → Role - _ → _ → _ → Editor - _ → _ → _ → Editor

4. Plugin licenses

Elementor Pro

- License email: _
- License key: _
- Purchase date: _
- Renewal date: _
- Renewal URL: <https://my.elementor.com/>

Advanced Custom Fields Pro

- License email: _
- License key: _
- Purchase date: _
- Renewal URL: <https://www.advancedcustomfields.com/my-account/>

Yoast SEO Premium (if applicable)

- License email: _
- License key: _
- Renewal URL: <https://yoast.com/my-yoast/>

Wordfence Premium (if applicable)

- License email: _
- License key: _
- Renewal URL: <https://www.wordfence.com/central/>

Other plugin licenses

- _
-

5. Email / SMTP

Transactional email service

- **Provider:** *(SendGrid, Amazon SES, Postmark, Mailgun)*
- **Admin URL:** _
- **Account email:** _
- **API key:** _ (store in password manager)
- **From address:** _
- **Monthly send limit:** _

Google Workspace / Microsoft 365

- **Admin URL:** _
 - **Admin email:** _
 - **Admin password:** _
 - **Super admin email:** _
 - **Number of users:** _
 - **Monthly cost:** \$_
-

6. Marketing integrations

Mailchimp (or equivalent newsletter provider)

- **Admin URL:** _
- **Account email:** _
- **Password:** _
- **API key:** _
- **Audience name:** _
- **Plan:** _

HubSpot (if applicable)

- **Portal ID:** _
- **Admin email:** _
- **API key:** _

Social media accounts

Twitter/X - Handle: @_ - Account email: _ - Password: _

LinkedIn - Page URL: _ - Admin email: _

Facebook - Page URL: _ - Admin email: _

Instagram - Handle: @_ - Account email: _

YouTube - Channel URL: _ - Admin email: _

7. Analytics & Search

Google Analytics 4

- **Property ID:** _
- **Measurement ID:** G-__
- **Admin email:** _
- **URL:** <https://analytics.google.com/>

Google Search Console

- **Property:** <https://centerforhoustonfuture.org/>
- **Verified by:** *(DNS, HTML file, meta tag, Analytics)*
- **Admin email:** _

Google Tag Manager (if applicable)

- **Container ID:** GTM-__
- **Admin email:** _

Bing Webmaster Tools (if applicable)

- **Admin email:** _
-

8. CDN / Performance

Cloudflare

- **Account email:** _
- **Password:** _
- **API token:** _
- **Zone ID:** _
- **Plan:** _ (Free / Pro / Business)

Other CDN / edge

- _
-

9. Backups

Backup storage account

- **Provider:** *(Dropbox, Google Drive, Backblaze, AWS S3)*
- **Account email:** _

- Password: _
 - API credentials: _
 - Retention policy: _ (e.g., daily for 30 days)
-

10. Monitoring

Uptime monitor

- Provider: (*UptimeRobot, Better Uptime*)
- Account email: _
- Dashboard URL: _
- Alert contacts: _

Error monitor (if applicable)

- Provider: _
 - Account email: _
 - Dashboard URL: _
-

11. Third-party services

reCAPTCHA

- Site key: _
- Secret key: _
- Admin URL: <https://www.google.com/recaptcha/admin>

Stripe (if payments enabled)

- Account email: _
- Publishable key: pk_live_
- Secret key: sk_live_ (NEVER commit)

Other services

- _
-

12. Emergency contacts

Vendor / developer

- Company: reneka DIGITAL
- Primary contact: _

- Email: _
- Phone: _
- Support hours: _

Hosting support

- Support URL: _
- Support phone: _
- Emergency escalation: _

Registrar support

- Support URL: _
- Support phone: _

13. Important URLs quick reference

Service	URL
Live site	https://centerforhoustonfuture.org
WordPress admin	https://centerforhoustonfuture.org/wp-admin/
Hosting panel	—
DNS panel	—
Google Analytics	https://analytics.google.com/
Google Search Console	https://search.google.com/search-console
Elementor account	https://my.elementor.com/
Cloudflare dashboard	https://dash.cloudflare.com/

14. Password rotation schedule

Update these credentials on the schedule below:

Credential	Rotation frequency	Last rotated
WordPress admin	Every 90 days	–
Hosting account	Every 180 days	–
Database password	Every 180 days	–
SFTP password	Every 180 days	–
API keys (Stripe, SendGrid, etc.)	Every 365 days	–
reCAPTCHA secret	Only if compromised	–

When a team member leaves: - [] Remove their WordPress user account - [] Remove them from hosting account - [] Remove from Google Workspace / email - [] Remove from password manager shared vault - [] Rotate any shared passwords they had access to - [] Revoke any personal API keys they generated

15. License & renewal tracker

Service	Cost	Renewal	Auto-renew
Domain	\$_/yr	–	–
Hosting	\$_/mo	–	–
Elementor Pro	\$_/yr	–	–
ACF Pro	\$_/yr	–	–
SSL cert	\$_	–	–
Google Workspace	\$_/mo	–	–
Backup storage	\$_/mo	–	–
Uptime monitor	\$_/mo	–	–
CDN	\$_/mo	–	–
TOTAL MONTHLY	\$_		
TOTAL ANNUAL	\$_		

Last updated: _ Updated by: _